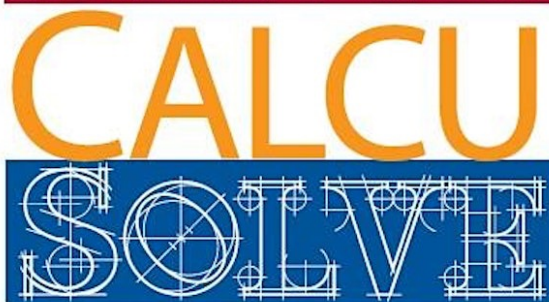


December QUEST Newsletter

ALLEGHENY INTERMEDIATE UNIT



Calculusolve Competition

December 16th at 9:30am

CalcuSolve is a virtual math competition for students in grades 9-12 that tests students' problem-solving skills as individuals, and as part of a team of up to 4 students. There are a total of 9 math problems, 7 individual and 2 team. Points are earned based on correct answers given during a set amount of time.

Team registrations are due December 4th. Email Lesley_Cowles@fcasd.edu to participate! Permission slips are available in the QUEST Student Center (room 168).

IMPORTANT DATES:

12/1: No School

12/1 – Time to start thinking about and applying to summer programs!

12/1: Congressional Seminar Essay Contest submission deadline

12/1: Registration open for US National Chemistry Olympiad

12/1: USA Mathematical Talent Search Round 2 due

12/4: Calculusolve team registration deadline

12/4: Math Madness during QRT, Library Classroom

12/10: Math Madness during QRT, Library Classroom

12/12: Career speakers during QRT

12/12: Chemistry Olympiad practice round during QRT

12/16: Calculusolve Competition

12/17: ASMA Math Competition, QRT, Library Classroom

12/24-1/2: Winter Break

12/31: I Look Like a Cardiologist application deadline

1/1: MIT Think Scholars application deadline



International Academic Competitions UNITED STATES DIVISION



National
Science Bee

February 24, 2026
During QRT in the
Library Classroom



NATIONAL
POLITICAL
SCIENCE
BEE

February 26, 2026
During QRT in the
Library Classroom



National
Biology Bee

February 27, 2026
During QRT in the
Library Classroom



United States
History Bee

March 3, 2026
During QRT in the Library
Classroom



National
Geography Bee

March 5, 2026
During QRT in the
Library Classroom



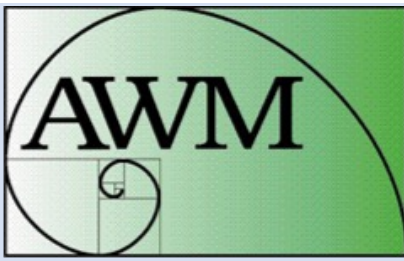
National
Humanities Bee

March 6, 2026
During QRT in the Library
Classroom

***The FCAHS Department is proud
to host and cover the
registration fees for all round 1
participants of these
international academic
competitions.***

***Further competition advancement
registration and fees will be the
responsibility of the student.***

***All interested students should contact
Lesley_Cowles@fcasd.edu. Registration
forms are available in the QUEST office***



Association for Women in Mathematics

Women in Mathematics Essay Contest

To increase awareness of women's ongoing contributions to the mathematical sciences, the Association for Women in Mathematics (AWM) and Math for America co-sponsor an essay contest for biographies of contemporary women mathematicians and statisticians in academic, industrial, and government careers. The essays will be based primarily on an interview with a woman currently working in or retired from a mathematical sciences career.

Deadline: February 1st.

There is one First Place Winner in each category (Grades 6-8, Grades 9-12, and Undergraduate) and a Grand Prize Winner chosen from among those three First Place Winners. There are also typically 0-3 Honorable Mentions in each category.

The winners (including Honorable Mentions) receive a monetary prize, a membership in the Association for Women in Mathematics, and a certificate, and their names and affiliations are published in the AWM Newsletter. In addition, all of the essays are published online, and the Grand Prize winner's essay is published in the AWM Newsletter.

<https://awm-math.org/awards/student-essay-contest/>

Teen DJ Academy with Tech25 @ the Warhol

Learn to build and blend your own DJ sets that will get everyone on the dance floor! Presented in partnership with Tech 25, the Teen DJ Academy is a 12-week workshop series taught by professional DJs with the goal of providing hands-on experience with real equipment and opportunities to perform at Youth Invasion, LGBTQ+ Prom and other teen events. This program is free and meets on Mondays from 4-6 p.m. DJ Students will earn a stipend for attending workshop sessions plus additional stipends per performance. Participants must be ages 13-18 and space is limited.

Applications will be opening in January 2026 and available at <https://www.warhol.org/teens/>

For more information please contact teens@warhol.org
Co-presented with Tech25
The DJ Academy Workshops are generously supported by The Richard King Mellon Foundation and The Henry L. Hillman Foundation



North American Computational Linguistics Open Competition

You will miss 2nd and 3rd period classes to complete the test.

This Olympiad is a contest in which high-school students solve linguistic puzzles. In solving the problems, students learn about the diversity and consistency of language, while exercising logic skills. No prior knowledge of linguistics or second languages is necessary. Professionals in linguistics, computational linguistics and language technologies use dozens of languages to create engaging problems that represent cutting edge issues in their fields. The competition has attracted top students to study and work in those same fields. It is truly an opportunity for young people to experience a taste of natural-language processing in the 21st century.

Register on the NACLO website:

<https://reg.naclo.org/>. Choose your site to be "Fox Chapel Area High School" because we are hosting the initial round of testing.

NACLO - The North American Computational Linguistics Olympiad will be held at FCAHS on January 29 in the library classroom This exam is 3 hours long and winners will qualify to compete in the International Linguistics Olympiad.



Free Admission for Students Throughout December!

This holiday season, kids aged 17 and under can enjoy FREE admission to the History Center, Western Pennsylvania Sports Museum, and Fort Pitt Museum! This is the perfect opportunity for families to explore Pittsburgh's rich history, dive into fascinating exhibits, and learn about the region's sports heritage. Whether you're interested in the stories of Pittsburgh's past or the iconic moments in sports history, there's something for everyone to discover.

Open Heart Surgery Observation January 15, 2026

*** This opportunity is limited to 8 students.***

Preference is given to juniors and seniors who plan to major in a field of medicine and who have not previously attended an open heart surgery observation. We will depart for Allegheny General Hospital at 7:10am, so you must get a ride to school that morning if your bus typically arrives to school later than that time.

Email Lisa_Gibson@fcsd.edu if you are interested in attending and she will be in touch.





I LOOK LIKE A CARDIOLOGIST



APPLY NOW!!

I Look Like a Cardiologist is an outreach and mentorship program designed to inspire the next generation of heart doctors from diverse backgrounds. Through interactive sessions and mentorship from practicing cardiologists, high school students will explore what it's like to work in this exciting field.

Their goal is to spark curiosity, build confidence, and create opportunities for students who may not see themselves represented in cardiology today but will shape its future tomorrow. Register now to learn, connect, and see that you, too, can look like a cardiologist.

Sessions will take place February 3rd, February 10th, February 24th from 7pm to 8:15pm over zoom. Sign-ups will close December 31st, 2026.

Find more information at:

<https://www.ilooklikeacardiologist.com/>



2025 – 2026 NATIONAL HIGH SCHOOL POETRY CONTEST

- Open to high school students and home-schooled students in grades 9 through 12 from anywhere in the United States
- 1 – 2 poems with a maximum of 40 lines each
- No entry may have been previously published
- Winners will receive a monetary prize, a signed copy of Matthew Shenoda's latest book, recognition at Gannon University's 49th Annual Writing Awards Night, and publication in Gannon University's award-winning literary journal, *Totem*.
- Winners and Honorable Mentions will be notified in March
- Submit poems by February 1

For more information, contact: highschoolpoetry@gannon.edu

AWARDS

First Place: \$50

Second Place: \$40

Third Place: \$30

Berwyn Moore Young Erie Poet Award: \$50

SUBMIT POEMS HERE:



GANNON
UNIVERSITY

FOR FULL GUIDELINES AND TO SUBMIT, PLEASE VISIT
WWW.GANNON.EDU/POETRYCONTEST



*Pine-Richland High School
presents...*

Race Day

STEAM Competition

Monday, March 23, 2026

8:30 AM – 12:30 PM @ Pine-Richland High School

We will be bringing one team of 5 students to this competition. FC covers the cost of the \$100 registration fee and cost of materials (up to \$500). This year's competition, titled Race Day: Precision Braking Cart Challenge, invites students to design and test an engineering solution focused on controlled motion and precision.

Competition Includes:

- Building a precision braking cart.
- Four additional "day- of" STEAM group challenges
- One team of five students per team per school can register
- It is recommended that at least 1-2 team members have completed Pre-Calculus, as some mathematical problems may be too difficult otherwise.
- Grab & go breakfast and lunch will be provided along with prizes and awards for the winners!
- **Space is limited, so email Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu today if you are interested in being considered for the team.**



ACS
Chemistry for Life®

U.S. National Chemistry Olympiad

- The U.S. National Chemistry Olympiad (USNCO) program is a multi-tiered chemistry competition for high school students. ACS has sponsored the program since 1984.
- Competition locations are throughout the Western Pennsylvania region.**

October 6, 2025	Student registration open
February 27 - March 16, 2026	Local Exam
April 10-19, 2026	National Exam
June 2026 TBD	Study Camp
July 2026 TBD	International Chemistry Olympiad

The program has four tiers

The U.S. National Chemistry Olympiad (USNCO) program is a chemistry competition for high school students. ACS has sponsored the program since 1984. The program has four tiers:

- MARCH**
Local Chemistry Olympiad Exams
The first step in USNCO, held each March. High school students can participate by registering with ACS. Registration does not guarantee participation. Students will be notified by their ACS Local Section Coordinator. Coordinators choose nominees for the National Exam based on results of the local competition.
- APRIL**
National Chemistry Olympiad Exams
A three-part exam administered to more than 1,000 students each April. National Exams are often hosted by ACS Local Sections at local universities and colleges.
- JUNE**
Study Camp
The 20 top-scoring students from the National Exam spend two weeks at a Study Camp in June to undergo rigorous training. Based on their performance, four students are chosen to represent the U.S. at the International Chemistry Olympiad.
- JULY**
International Chemistry Olympiad Exams
The four international competitors are accompanied by mentors who translate the test, inspect laboratories and arbitrate the scoring of the exams. Students and mentors also have opportunities to interact with one another and experience the host country's culture through planned educational and social events.



Local Exams Format

Multiple Choice

110 min | 60 multiple-choice questions
Covers broad chemistry topics

Contact Dr. Cowles: Lesley_Cowles@fcasd.edu

All high school students are eligible to participate!

Pre-Register by: December 11th

Practice Competition: December 12th During QRT

Competition: January 9th (7:45-9:45)

Permission Slips Due: January 7th

Tentative Dates:

- Practice Test Date:
- Competition Date Either: January 8th 11:30-1:30 (students eat A lunch) or January 9th 7:45-9:45.
 - Permission Slips Needed

Understand the exam format



Local Exams Format

Multiple Choice

110 min | 60 multiple-choice questions
Covers broad chemistry topics



National Exams Format

Part I: Problem Solving

90 min | 60 multiple-choice questions
Covers broad chemistry topics

Part II: Problem Solving

105 min | 8 written questions
Covers chemical theories and models

Part III: Lab Practical

90 min | 2 laboratory practicals
Involves problem solving in the laboratory



Multiple Choice Topics

Multiple choice USNCO (both local and national) exams cover the following topics:

QUESTIONS	TOPIC
1 - 6	Stoichiometry/Solutions
7 - 12	Descriptive/Laboratory
13 - 18	States Of Matter
19 - 24	Thermodynamics
25 - 30	Kinetics
31 - 36	Equilibrium
37 - 42	Oxidation - Reduction
43 - 48	Atomic Structure/Periodicity
49 - 54	Bonding/Molecular Structure
55 - 60	Organic/Biochemistry



APPLY FOR CARNEGIE MELLON'S SUMMER ACADEMY FOR MATH & SCIENCE (SAMS)

.....

SAMS is a pre-college program that provides opportunities for rising high school seniors who are underrepresented in STEM-related fields. SAMS is a fully funded, merit based program.

To be eligible for the SAMS program, students must:

- Be at least 16 years old by the program start date.
- Be a U.S. citizen or permanent resident.
- Be in 11th grade at the time of application submission.

"From my time at SAMS, I learned so much about myself and college and met some of the most incredible people. This has been the best 6 weeks of my life, and this program is one I couldn't recommend enough."
-SAMS 2025 Participant

Program Dates: June 20 - August 1, 2026

Deadline to Apply: February 1, 2026

Decision Notification: April 15, 2026



cmu-sams@andrew.cmu.edu

Carnegie Mellon University
Center for Student Diversity
and Inclusion



Fox Chapel Area Online Summer 2026 Course Offerings

Open to students currently enrolled in grades 9, 10, and 11.

Online courses run for 5 weeks from

Friday, June 12 through Friday, July 17

Application deadline: February 28, 2026

FCAO Career and Financial Essentials



For students entering grades 11 or 12, **Career and Financial Essentials** complements all disciplines and other standards by developing postsecondary goals regarding career planning and financial literacy. Students will embark on a career search, compose a job application, and develop a personal résumé. Students will also learn about consumer skills, debit/credit, budgeting, and taxes. The culminating experience is a one-on-one professional interview that will be conducted in the fall. All activities are completed online. Assignments are due weekly, but students may work ahead, if desired.
.5 credits

FCAO SAT Prep



For students entering grades 11 or 12, **SAT Prep** helps students strengthen their skills using Khan Academy's SAT Practice modules to build test readiness. Students will complete two full-length, timed SAT practice tests to simulate real testing conditions and track their progress. Lessons focus on improving performance in Reading, Writing, and Math. Additionally, students learn test-taking strategies, including familiarity with the Bluebook testing app utilized by College Board. Weekly assignments help students stay accountable and steadily improve their scores.
.5 credits

FCAO Discovery Health



For students entering 10th grade, **Discovery Health** allows students to apply wellness concepts to the study of the human body. Utilizing basic facts about the body systems, students will discover how daily decisions can impact the operation of the human body. This is a required course for graduation from FCAHS. It meets the PA State Standards for Health, Safety, and Physical Education. All activities are completed online. Assignments are due weekly, but students may work ahead, if desired.
.5 credits

**** These are compressed courses. Students are completing an entire course in five weeks. ****

Frequently Asked Questions:

What is the format of these classes? These classes are fully online & asynchronous, with weekly due dates.

What if a student is on vacation for part of the 5 weeks? Students can choose to work while on vacation or complete their assignments ahead of time. The late work policy will apply to all students, regardless of travel plans, so it is important to plan accordingly.

What is the late work policy? Late work is accepted up to one week with a 20% penalty; no work is accepted beyond one week late. No work is accepted beyond the last day of class, Friday, July 17th. The expectation is that all students will follow the course schedule due to the compressed nature of the classes.

How much should be expected for these classes? These classes are the same semester-long classes compressed into five weeks.

Can a student take more than one course? It is possible, but the student should consider their schedule and availability to complete multiple semester courses in a five-week span.

How do I register? Spaces are limited and classes get full. Spots are filled on a first-come, first-serve basis. A student isn't enrolled until the form AND check are received. No refunds are available after June 1st.

Fox Chapel Area Online
Summer High School Course Registration
Courses run from June 12 – July 17
Open to students currently enrolled in grades 9, 10, and 11
Registration Deadline: February 28, 2026

I would like to register for the following summer course(s):

- ☐ FCAO College and Career Essentials (grades 11 & 12), \$200.00
 - ☐ FCAO SAT Prep (grades 11 & 12), \$200.00
 - ☐ FCAO Health (grade 10), \$200.00
-

Student Name: _____

Current Grade Level (circle): 9 10 11

Student Email: _____@student.fcasd.edu

Student Phone : _____

Parent/Guardian Name: _____

Parent/Guardian Phone: _____

Parent/Guardian Email: _____

SPACE IS VERY LIMITED!
STUDENTS ARE NOT ENROLLED
UNTIL REGISTRATION AND PAYMENT ARE SUBMITTED.
NO REFUNDS after June 1, 2026.

Please make check payable (separate check per course) to:
Fox Chapel Area School District (FCASD)

Submit check and form either in-person (high school room 168) or via mail to:

Lisa Gibson
FCAHS Summer School Registration
611 Field Club Road
Pittsburgh, PA 15238

Contact Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu (412-967-2479) with any questions.

**PRACTICE
MATERIALS
PROVIDED!**

WESTERN PENNSYLVANIA
LEARNING ACADEMY
presents

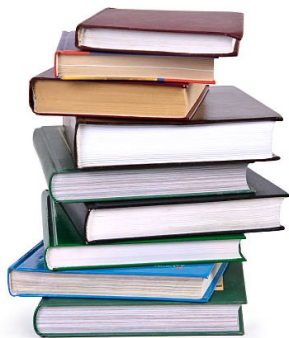
SAT[®]

**BOOT
CAMP**

Sunday, March 1, 2026

Noon – 5 p.m.

Fox Chapel Area High School LGI



- Test taking and time management tips
- Intensive grammar & usage skills review
- Intensive math skills review
- Critical reading skills and strategies
- Practice drills with actual test questions
- Experienced and highly-trained instructors

\$100
Cash or check
payable to FCASD

This program is most suitable for students who have successfully completed Algebra 2.

Please bring with you a graphing calculator and laptop.

Contact Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu if you do not have access to these items.

****PRE-REGISTRATION IS REQUIRED****

Student Name: _____ Grade: _____

Student Email: _____ School District: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Parent/Guardian Name: _____ Phone: _____

Parent/Guardian Email: _____

Please make checks payable to Fox Chapel Area School District (FCASD).

No refunds issued after February 25, 2026

*Submit check and completed registration form (front and back)
either in person (Fox Chapel Area High School room 168) or via mail to:*

Lisa Gibson, Director
Western PA Learning Academy
Fox Chapel Area High School
611 Field Club Road
Pittsburgh, PA 15238

The well-being of any child is a parental responsibility. In an emergency, every effort will be made to contact a parent/guardian. Please list two persons who can arrange transportation and care for your child when you are not available.

Relative or Friend: _____ Phone: _____
Relative or Friend: _____ Phone: _____

WESTERN PENNSYLVANIA LEARNING ACADEMY

Program Permission Form



Student Name: _____

I, _____ give permission for my child to attend the assigned date of the Western Pennsylvania Learning Academy's SAT Boot Camp. In the event of an emergency, if treatment is required and parents/guardians cannot be notified immediately, I give consent for emergency treatment and transport to the nearest emergency room.

Does your child have any health concerns that would hinder participation in the field experience? _____ No _____ Yes. If yes, please complete the following:

Please indicate if your child has any of the following health concerns:

_____ Asthma _____ Inhaler needed
_____ Life-threatening allergy to bee sting _____ EpiPen
_____ Life-threatening allergy to food _____ Benadryl needed
_____ Seizure disorder _____ Diabetes
_____ Allergy to _____ Other _____

Emergency Treatment (if needed): _____

Health Insurance: _____

Family Physician: _____ Phone: _____

My signature confirms that my child has permission to participate in all activities on the specified dates. Permission is also granted to share this information with appropriate academy personnel.

Parent Signature: _____ Date: _____

Cell Phone #: _____ Work Phone #: _____

Cancellation policy:

We understand situations arise when you may need to cancel your reservation. To do so, we request you notify us at least 24 hours in advance. This allows us to offer your slot to another student on the waiting list. Cancellations or rescheduling requests made less than 24 hours before the event may be subject to a cancellation fee of 30%. No-shows without prior notification will not be refunded. In case of emergencies or unforeseen circumstances, please contact us directly to discuss your situation. We may be able to waive the cancellation fee at our discretion.